

Environment Setup Review

Reviewer: Jason Chletsos · **New SE:** Anthony Bianay · Work through every step in order, on Anthony's machine, with Anthony driving. Check the box only when the pass condition is met.

PART A Accounts and access

☐ 1. Fivetran login works

Anthony logs into Fivetran (not you, not a shared screen) and lands on a dashboard he can read.

PASS: he can see the connector list and open a connector's detail page.

IF IT FAILS: resolve account/SSO access before anything else — nothing below works without it.

☐ 2. dbt Cloud login and IDE access

He logs into dbt Cloud, opens the sandbox project, and launches the Cloud IDE.

PASS: the file tree shows `models/`, `seeds/`, `macros/`, `tests/`, and `dbt_project.yml`.

IF IT FAILS: he may have a dbt Cloud seat but no access to this project — fix project permissions, not the IDE.

PART B Fivetran side: connector and first sync

☐ 3. Sandbox connector exists and points at an MDLS destination

Open his connector. Confirm it targets the Managed Data Lake Service destination (S3 + Glue), or the equivalent sandbox destination, and that the destination schema is clearly prefixed with his own name so his sandbox syncs are identifiable in a shared workspace.

PASS: connector card shows the MDLS (or equivalent) destination and a sensible schema name.

☐ 4. First sync has completed — and he knows where to verify it

Check sync status in the Fivetran UI together, then open the connector's **schema tab**. Tell him explicitly: this tab is the ground truth his bronze `sources.yml` must match 1:1, because bronze does no renaming.

PASS: sync shows complete; he can name the tables that landed.

IF IT FAILS: a build against a half-finished sync is the most common live-demo failure — wait for the sync, do not proceed on a partial one.

PART C dbt Cloud side: environments, Git, and a clean build

☐ 5. Development and Deployment environments both exist

Open the project's environment settings. Confirm a Development environment (his IDE session, his own dev schema) and a Deployment environment (what scheduled jobs run against), and that he can say which is which. Demos live and die by knowing which one you're looking at.

PASS: both environments exist and Development targets his own schema, not a shared one.

☐ 6. **Git works from the IDE**

Have him create a scratch branch directly from the Cloud IDE before touching anything. This proves repo write access, not just read.

PASS: branch created and shown as active in the IDE.

☐ 7. **Bronze / silver / gold scaffold is in place**

Check the file tree for `models/bronze`, `models/silver`, `models/gold`. Bronze should contain only `sources.yml` (no SQL models); silver holds `stg_[source]__[table].sql` views; gold holds `dim_ / fct_` models with Iceberg config.

PASS: all three folders exist and follow the naming pattern.

☐ 8. **A full build runs clean from the IDE**

From the Cloud IDE command bar, on his scratch branch:

```
dbt build --select bronze silver gold
```

PASS: build completes with 0 errors, into his dev schema.

IF IT FAILS: an immediate connection error means the environment's warehouse credentials are expired or point at a destination he can't reach — fix the environment's connection settings before debugging any SQL. Missing-column errors mean `sources.yml` drifted from what actually synced — recheck against the schema tab from step 4, not memory. If `table_type='iceberg'` errors, the sandbox may be DuckDB-backed — drop that config and materialize a plain table.

☐ 9. **Docs DAG opens**

Open docs (the book icon) and have him click through the existing DAG — he'll be adding to one just like it in Session 6.

PASS: DAG renders and he can trace one model from bronze source to gold.

PART D **dbt Wizard**

☐ 10. **Wizard installed and authenticated**

On his machine:

```
gcloud auth application-default login
dbt-wizard
```

PASS: a session starts inside the sandbox dbt project with no auth error.

IF IT FAILS: expired `gcloud` application-default credentials are the single most common pre-demo hiccup — re-run the login. If `dbt-wizard` isn't found, run the install script from the course cheat sheet first.

☐ 11. **One real Wizard question, end to end**

Have him ask a plain-English business question (the course's own: *"Why do some stores keep showing inventory variance on Item A?"*) and watch the sequence run: search, describe, lineage, warehouse, then `dbt_compile`.

PASS: he can state the safety rule in his own words — nothing touches the warehouse until he approves the compiled preview, and approved runs land only in his own dev schema, never a shared or production one.

☐ 12. **Course site and cheat sheet**

He opens the dbt Academy site, Session 1, with the cheat sheet in a second tab. Set the expectation: Sessions 1–6 in order, at his own pace, actually completing each checkpoint — plus the two bonus deep-dives before he presents to anyone.

PASS: site loads, he knows the working order, and he knows the "if something breaks" section exists in every session.

FAST REFERENCE — THE FOUR FAILURES TO CHECK BEFORE ANY LIVE RUN

1. Sync not finished → bronze source tests fail: always confirm sync status in Fivetran first. 2. `sources.yml` drift → missing-column build errors: recheck the connector's schema tab. 3. Wizard auth expired → re-run `gcloud auth application-default login` before the call. 4. Connection error on `dbt build` → environment credentials, not the SQL.

SIGN-OFF — ALL 12 STEPS PASSED

Anthony Bianay · date _____

Jason Chletsos · date _____